

A healthy trim to weight-loss drugs

Trump deal cuts prices as insurers balk at coverage

By Jonathan Saltzman and Jessica Bartlett
GLOBE STAFF

Rachel Brophy is no fan of President Trump, but she said he did something last week that will ease a little of the financial pain she expects to start feeling next year.

Brophy, a 38-year-old registered nurse at Brigham and Women's Hospital, takes a pricey weight-loss drug called Zepbound. She is delighted with the injectable medicine and was angry that her health insurer will stop covering it starting Jan. 1.

Brophy, of Topsfield, has a co-pay of only \$10 a month. Without coverage, however, she was preparing to pay Zepbound's manufacturer, Eli Lilly, \$400 to \$500 a month out of pocket to stay on the prescribed medicine, which helped her shed 20 pounds.

Then the Trump administration announced a deal on Thursday that will cut the direct-to-consumer price for the so-called GLP-1 drug to an average of \$350 a month and could ultimately lower it to about \$150.

"Believe me, I would have loved for it to just stay \$10," said Brophy, but paying \$350 a

month is better than \$500. "That would put a strain on our finances."

As many insurers and employers backpedal on covering weight-loss medications, Trump has offered a lifeline that could help more people get the medicines they want. But health experts warn that

WEIGHT LOSS DRUGS, Page A13

Scrutiny of a side door into Harvard

US examining visa practices of Chinese art lab

By Deirdre Fernandes
GLOBE STAFF

Nearly a decade ago, Harvard University professor Eugene Wang set out to build an expansive multimedia lab in Chinese art, one that could replicate the experience of being in a Buddhist cave by using digital and virtual reality tools to transport audiences to northwestern China.

It was an esoteric proposal, but it landed amid a push to expand Harvard's presence abroad. Wang, an expert in Asian art, had no problem finding Chinese backers eager to establish a foothold at the nation's oldest university.

In 2017, his effort paid off: Wang got \$2 million to launch his initiative from a fund set up by the Wanda Group, a huge Chinese commercial real estate firm. The fund, operated out of then-university president Drew Faust's office, was specifically geared for "ambitious projects that bring together Harvard faculty and Chinese collaborators," according to a Harvard an-

HARVARD, Page A16



BRETT PHELPS FOR THE GLOBE
Carlo DeMaria had been mayor of Everett for nearly 18 years.

A durable survivor's reign is at an end

DeMaria finds Everett voters had enough

By Brian MacQuarrie and Stephanie Ebbert
GLOBE STAFF

Mayor Carlo DeMaria of Everett has been an outsize presence in this densely packed, industrial city for his entire adult life, since his 1993 election to the Board of Aldermen as a Northeastern University student to nearly 18 years as its swaggering mayor.

DeMaria talked big and usually had popularity ratings to match, but now it is over. His bid for a seventh term was derailed last week amid a cascade of controversy, largely over \$180,000 in "longevity" bonuses that he orchestrated for himself and then hid in the budget, according to a report by the state inspector general.

Robert Van Campen, a city councilor, defeated DeMaria, 4,118 votes to 3,440, despite Van Campen's campaign being outspent by more than \$600,000.

"The catalyst was an incredible people-power, grassroots campaign for change," Van Campen said in an interview. "We talked about a community that was hungry for change, and they really were ready for change, to usher in and write a new chapter after 18 years."

According to interviews with city officials, immigrant advocates, and youth activists, that change has been driven by groups that had long felt overlooked by an increasingly insular government in their city of 51,000 residents on the Mystic River.

DeMARIA, Page A17

The ghosts of his war, laid to rest

A Marine veteran was haunted by his role in the death of a friend — until a chance meeting decades later

STORY BY KEVIN CULLEN AND PHOTOS BY JOHN TLUMACKI | GLOBE STAFF



Ed Kochanowski (left) and Ray Grasso comforted one another at the grave of Paul Grasso, Ray's brother and Kochanowski's comrade in Vietnam. Below, Ray Grasso held a portrait of his brother.

Ed Kochanowski was conceived amid the ruins of a world war and has lived through other wars since, from those that simmered during his upbringing in South Boston, that heated up at the Marine testing grounds of Parris Island and boiled over in the killing fields of Vietnam. And most important, with the guilt he brought back with him — the things he carried.

But only recently have those wars truly ended for Kochanowski — and because of something just short of a miracle.

To understand all this, the story begins in the spring of 1968, a seminal moment in the war in Vietnam.



"That day shattered our family. . . . None of us were ever quite the same."

RAY GRASSO, speaking of the day the family learned Paul Grasso had been killed in Vietnam

Two young Marines — members of India Company, Third Battalion, Third Marine Regiment, Third Marine Division — were outside Khe Sanh, where the fighting was intense.

The two Marines had grown up just a few miles from each other across Dorchester Bay. Kochanowski, 18 years old, was from Southie; Paul Grasso, 19, was from Quincy — "Southie with trees," as the joke went.

They became fast friends when they met in Vietnam. They had each other's back.

They were on patrol, fording a stream, when the strap on the mortar pack Kochanowski was lugging broke. He was waist-deep in water, grasping at the broken strap to keep the mortars dry, as Grasso mounted a steep, muddy bank ahead of him.

One by one, as they climbed the riverbank, each Marine turned to help the one behind him out of the water. When Grasso reached the bank, he turned back and saw Kochanowski struggling.

With one hand on the broken strap, Kochanowski reached out his M-16 so Grasso could use it to pull him out of the water.

Kochanowski braced his foot against the muddy bank, and Grasso pulled him up. Kochanowski was almost at the

VIETNAM, Page A18

SHUTDOWN DAY 40

14
Failed Senate votes

Sept. 19
Date of last House session

594,048
Workers furloughed

35 days
Previous shutdown record

Feeling the shutdown

Disruptions to travel forced many to change their plans, and confusion over SNAP continued. The Senate was in session, trying to find a path forward. **A11, B1.**

See ways to celebrate the season with dance, theater, music, TV, and more in the Holiday Arts Guide. **SundayArts, N1.**

A cloud shot

Sunday: Cloudy, cooler. High: 53-58. Low: 48-53.

Monday: Ditto. Complete report, **A26.**

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